Americans on AI — Pilot Release

Athena Insights surveyed 1,799 US adults from June 12-18, 2026, via an opt-in web panel, with quotas balanced to US population benchmarks on sex, age, ethnicity, and political affiliation.

This release includes the results of that survey as a whole-sample topline, then as crosstabs broken out by subgroup, followed by appendices covering the questionnaire, methodology, and unweighted sample composition.

Results are weighted to US population targets; the full-sample margin of error is ±2.4 percentage points at 95% confidence, accounting for the design effect of weighting. Percentages are out of all respondents, with "Not sure" and "None" answers included.

You can find the underlying data and live visuals for this and other surveys at americanson.ai.

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Topline

These are the whole-sample results: for each question, the distribution table gives the full breakdown: the share choosing each option.

Totals that group those options (e.g. total excited, total concerned) and the nets between them appear in the crosstabs that follow.

Priorities

> *We are faced with many problems in this country, and resources are often limited. Given these constraints, how much of a priority should the government place on each of the following?*

Each label stands for a full item:

Label	Item
Jobs	Improving the job situation
Inflation	Reducing inflation
AI harms	Dealing with harms from artificial intelligence (AI)
Immigration	Dealing with immigration
Health care	Improving health care
Crime	Reducing crime
Climate change	Dealing with climate change

Response distribution (weighted) — % of all respondents.

Item	Top priority	Important but lower priority	Not too important	Not a priority at all	Not sure
Jobs	51 %	40 %	7 %	2 %	<1 %
Inflation	71 %	25 %	3 %	1 %	<1 %
AI harms	30 %	43 %	19 %	7 %	1 %
Immigration	29 %	34 %	24 %	12 %	1 %
Health care	70 %	25 %	4 %	1 %	<1 %
Crime	47 %	37 %	12 %	3 %	<1 %
Climate change	41 %	31 %	13 %	14 %	1 %

Affect

Thinking about AI's growing role in society, which of these options comes closest to how you feel, even if none are exactly right?

Response distribution (weighted) — % of all respondents.

Response	%
Very excited	13 %
Somewhat excited	27 %
Somewhat concerned	36 %
Very concerned	22 %
None of these are close to how I feel	2 %

Agency

Again, thinking about AI, which statement comes closer to your view, even if neither is exactly right?

Response distribution (weighted) — % of all respondents.

Response	%
People like me can shape how much AI is part of our lives	31 %
AI is coming into our lives whether we want it or not	69 %

Community

Thinking about your local community, how much are you seeing each of the following changes because of AI?

Each label stands for a full item:

Label	Item
Saving time	People are saving time on everyday tasks
Pressured to do more	People are pressured to do more, faster
Losing connections	People are losing connections to others
Real vs. fake	People are struggling to tell what's real from what's fake
Better health care	People are getting better health care

Response distribution (weighted) — % of all respondents.

Item	Have seen	Starting to see	Expect to see soon	Don't expect to see	Not sure
Saving time	34 %	32 %	17 %	10 %	8 %
Pressured to do more	24 %	29 %	26 %	14 %	8 %
Losing connections	33 %	31 %	17 %	14 %	5 %
Real vs. fake	67 %	24 %	4 %	3 %	2 %
Better health care	4 %	13 %	27 %	42 %	14 %

Families

Thinking about families in America today, how is AI affecting each of the following?

Each label stands for a full item:

Label	Item
Jobs	Job security
Future	Outlook on the future
Children	Children's well-being
Finances	Household finances

Response distribution (weighted) — % of all respondents.

Item	Making it much better	Making it somewhat better	Making it somewhat worse	Making it much worse	Having no effect
Jobs	2 %	8 %	41 %	44 %	4 %
Future	6 %	34 %	33 %	22 %	5 %
Children	3 %	16 %	35 %	34 %	13 %
Finances	4 %	30 %	26 %	15 %	25 %

Government

When it comes to each of the following issues, is the government doing too much, too little, or about the right amount in response?

Each label stands for a full item:

Label	Item
Children	AI's effects on children and young people
Environment	AI's environmental footprint, including from data centers
Workers	AI's effects on workers and jobs
Competitiveness	AI's effect on American competitiveness

Response distribution (weighted) — % of all respondents.

Item	Way too much	Somewhat too much	About the right amount	Somewhat too little	Way too little	Not sure
Children	8 %	9 %	13 %	23 %	39 %	8 %
Environment	10 %	8 %	13 %	17 %	47 %	5 %
Workers	8 %	10 %	14 %	25 %	39 %	5 %
Competitiveness	5 %	10 %	30 %	20 %	18 %	17 %

Futures

Thinking about the next 20 years, how likely is each of the following to happen?

Each label stands for a full item:

Label	Item
Superintelligence	AI becoming smarter than humans at most tasks
Loss-of-control	AI systems behaving in ways their developers did not intend
Breakthroughs	AI making major scientific and medical breakthroughs
WMDs	AI being used to create weapons of mass destruction

Response distribution (weighted) — % of all respondents.

Item	Already happening	Likely to happen	Unlikely to happen	Not at all likely to happen	Not sure
Superintelligence	30 %	43 %	15 %	7 %	5 %
Loss-of-control	35 %	45 %	12 %	3 %	5 %
Breakthroughs	22 %	53 %	12 %	4 %	7 %
WMDs	19 %	50 %	13 %	5 %	13 %

Crosstabs

Here we are reporting totals and nets for response options, shown for the whole sample and then broken out by sex, party, age, and ethnicity (the *banner*).

- A total is a combination of response options which indicate a common lean, for example: the total excited includes "very excited" and "somewhat excited" responses.
- A net is the gap, in percentage points, between the two leans of a question, for example: the total concerned minus the total excited.

One table per banner dimension (Total repeated as the first column). The base row is each subgroup's full size; columns with n<100 are marked †.

Priorities

> *We are faced with many problems in this country, and resources are often limited. Given these constraints, how much of a priority should the government place on each of the following?*

Each label stands for a full item:

Label	Item
Jobs	Improving the job situation
Inflation	Reducing inflation
AI harms	Dealing with harms from artificial intelligence (AI)
Immigration	Dealing with immigration
Health care	Improving health care
Crime	Reducing crime
Climate change	Dealing with climate change

Each total combines multiple responses:

Total	Responses
TOTAL high priority	"Top priority" or "Important but lower priority"
TOTAL lower priority	"Not too important" or "Not a priority at all"

Cells (weighted): totals (%) and net (percentage points).

By Sex

Item	Metric	Total	Female	Male
Base (n)		1799	915	884
Jobs	TOTAL high priority	91 %	93 %	89 %
	TOTAL lower priority	9 %	7 %	11 %
	NET priority	82 pp	86 pp	78 pp
Inflation	TOTAL high priority	96 %	98 %	95 %
	TOTAL lower priority	4 %	2 %	5 %
	NET priority	93 pp	96 pp	89 pp
AI harms	TOTAL high priority	73 %	77 %	68 %
	TOTAL lower priority	26 %	22 %	31 %
	NET priority	47 pp	56 pp	38 pp
Immigration	TOTAL high priority	63 %	65 %	61 %
	TOTAL lower priority	36 %	34 %	38 %
	NET priority	27 pp	31 pp	23 pp
Health care	TOTAL high priority	95 %	97 %	92 %
	TOTAL lower priority	5 %	3 %	7 %
	NET priority	90 pp	95 pp	85 pp
Crime	TOTAL high priority	85 %	89 %	80 %
	TOTAL lower priority	15 %	11 %	19 %
	NET priority	70 pp	78 pp	61 pp
Climate change	TOTAL high priority	72 %	76 %	68 %
	TOTAL lower priority	27 %	23 %	31 %
	NET priority	45 pp	53 pp	37 pp

By Party

Item	Metric	Total	Dem	Rep	Ind
Base (n)		1799	529	489	781
Jobs	TOTAL high priority	91 %	93 %	87 %	92 %
	TOTAL lower priority	9 %	7 %	13 %	7 %
	NET priority	82 pp	86 pp	73 pp	85 pp
Inflation	TOTAL high priority	96 %	96 %	97 %	96 %
	TOTAL lower priority	4 %	4 %	3 %	4 %
	NET priority	93 pp	92 pp	95 pp	91 pp
AI harms	TOTAL high priority	73 %	78 %	64 %	75 %
	TOTAL lower priority	26 %	21 %	35 %	23 %
	NET priority	47 pp	56 pp	28 pp	52 pp
Immigration	TOTAL high priority	63 %	44 %	88 %	61 %
	TOTAL lower priority	36 %	55 %	12 %	38 %
	NET priority	27 pp	−11 pp	75 pp	23 pp
Health care	TOTAL high priority	95 %	99 %	90 %	95 %
	TOTAL lower priority	5 %	1 %	10 %	5 %
	NET priority	90 pp	99 pp	80 pp	90 pp
Crime	TOTAL high priority	85 %	76 %	93 %	85 %
	TOTAL lower priority	15 %	23 %	6 %	15 %
	NET priority	70 pp	53 pp	87 pp	70 pp
Climate change	TOTAL high priority	72 %	92 %	48 %	74 %
	TOTAL lower priority	27 %	8 %	51 %	26 %
	NET priority	45 pp	84 pp	−3 pp	48 pp

By Age

Item	Metric	Total	18–34	35–49	50–64	65+
Base (n)		1799	538	462	561	238
Jobs	TOTAL high priority	91 %	93 %	93 %	89 %	88 %
	TOTAL lower priority	9 %	7 %	7 %	10 %	12 %
	NET priority	82 pp	86 pp	86 pp	79 pp	76 pp
Inflation	TOTAL high priority	96 %	95 %	95 %	97 %	98 %
	TOTAL lower priority	4 %	5 %	4 %	3 %	2 %
	NET priority	93 pp	90 pp	91 pp	94 pp	96 pp
AI harms	TOTAL high priority	73 %	73 %	71 %	72 %	75 %
	TOTAL lower priority	26 %	26 %	28 %	26 %	23 %
	NET priority	47 pp	47 pp	43 pp	46 pp	52 pp
Immigration	TOTAL high priority	63 %	54 %	61 %	68 %	72 %
	TOTAL lower priority	36 %	45 %	38 %	31 %	28 %
	NET priority	27 pp	9 pp	22 pp	37 pp	44 pp
Health care	TOTAL high priority	95 %	94 %	95 %	95 %	96 %
	TOTAL lower priority	5 %	6 %	4 %	5 %	4 %
	NET priority	90 pp	88 pp	91 pp	90 pp	92 pp
Crime	TOTAL high priority	85 %	83 %	82 %	86 %	88 %
	TOTAL lower priority	15 %	17 %	18 %	14 %	11 %
	NET priority	70 pp	65 pp	64 pp	73 pp	77 pp
Climate change	TOTAL high priority	72 %	80 %	74 %	67 %	66 %
	TOTAL lower priority	27 %	19 %	26 %	32 %	34 %
	NET priority	45 pp	61 pp	48 pp	35 pp	32 pp

By Ethnicity

Item	Metric	Total	White	Black	Asian	Mixed	Other
Base (n)		1799	1146	211	108	198	136
Jobs	TOTAL high priority	91 %	89 %	95 %	90 %	94 %	93 %
	TOTAL lower priority	9 %	10 %	4 %	9 %	5 %	7 %
	NET priority	82 pp	79 pp	91 pp	81 pp	89 pp	86 pp
Inflation	TOTAL high priority	96 %	96 %	97 %	95 %	95 %	96 %
	TOTAL lower priority	4 %	4 %	3 %	3 %	4 %	4 %
	NET priority	93 pp	93 pp	94 pp	92 pp	91 pp	91 pp
AI harms	TOTAL high priority	73 %	75 %	72 %	62 %	76 %	67 %
	TOTAL lower priority	26 %	24 %	27 %	38 %	24 %	30 %
	NET priority	47 pp	50 pp	45 pp	24 pp	52 pp	36 pp
Immigration	TOTAL high priority	63 %	63 %	64 %	70 %	59 %	61 %
	TOTAL lower priority	36 %	36 %	36 %	28 %	41 %	38 %
	NET priority	27 pp	27 pp	28 pp	42 pp	18 pp	23 pp
Health care	TOTAL high priority	95 %	95 %	97 %	92 %	96 %	94 %
	TOTAL lower priority	5 %	5 %	2 %	7 %	4 %	5 %
	NET priority	90 pp	90 pp	96 pp	85 pp	91 pp	89 pp
Crime	TOTAL high priority	85 %	83 %	92 %	86 %	82 %	87 %
	TOTAL lower priority	15 %	17 %	8 %	12 %	17 %	12 %
	NET priority	70 pp	67 pp	83 pp	74 pp	64 pp	75 pp
Climate change	TOTAL high priority	72 %	71 %	80 %	72 %	75 %	66 %
	TOTAL lower priority	27 %	28 %	19 %	29 %	24 %	33 %
	NET priority	45 pp	43 pp	60 pp	43 pp	52 pp	33 pp

Affect

Thinking about AI's growing role in society, which of these options comes closest to how you feel, even if none are exactly right?

Each total combines multiple responses:

Total	Responses
TOTAL excited	"Very excited" or "Somewhat excited"
TOTAL concerned	"Somewhat concerned" or "Very concerned"

Cells (weighted): totals (%) and net (percentage points).

By Sex

Metric	Total	Female	Male
Base (n)	1799	915	884
TOTAL excited	40 %	36 %	45 %
TOTAL concerned	58 %	63 %	53 %
None of these	2 %	2 %	2 %
NET concerned	18 pp	27 pp	7 pp

By Party

Metric	Total	Dem	Rep	Ind
Base (n)	1799	529	489	781
TOTAL excited	40 %	35 %	52 %	37 %
TOTAL concerned	58 %	65 %	46 %	60 %
None of these	2 %	<1 %	1 %	3 %
NET concerned	18 pp	30 pp	−6 pp	23 pp

By Age

Metric	Total	18–34	35–49	50–64	65+
Base (n)	1799	538	462	561	238
TOTAL excited	40 %	33 %	43 %	46 %	41 %
TOTAL concerned	58 %	66 %	55 %	52 %	57 %
None of these	2 %	1 %	2 %	2 %	2 %
NET concerned	18 pp	33 pp	12 pp	5 pp	16 pp

By Ethnicity

Metric	Total	White	Black	Asian	Mixed	Other
Base (n)	1799	1146	211	108	198	136
TOTAL excited	40 %	38 %	53 %	55 %	37 %	33 %
TOTAL concerned	58 %	60 %	45 %	45 %	62 %	65 %
None of these	2 %	2 %	2 %	1 %	<1 %	2 %
NET concerned	18 pp	22 pp	−8 pp	−10 pp	25 pp	32 pp

Agency

Again, thinking about AI, which statement comes closer to your view, even if neither is exactly right?

Cells (weighted): totals (%) and net (percentage points).

By Sex

Metric	Total	Female	Male
Base (n)	1799	915	884
TOTAL can shape	31 %	32 %	29 %
TOTAL inevitable	69 %	68 %	71 %
NET inevitable	39 pp	36 pp	42 pp

By Party

Metric	Total	Dem	Rep	Ind
Base (n)	1799	529	489	781
TOTAL can shape	31 %	32 %	34 %	27 %
TOTAL inevitable	69 %	68 %	66 %	73 %
NET inevitable	39 pp	37 pp	31 pp	45 pp

By Age

Metric	Total	18–34	35–49	50–64	65+
Base (n)	1799	538	462	561	238
TOTAL can shape	31 %	33 %	33 %	30 %	26 %
TOTAL inevitable	69 %	67 %	67 %	70 %	74 %
NET inevitable	39 pp	34 pp	35 pp	40 pp	49 pp

By Ethnicity

Metric	Total	White	Black	Asian	Mixed	Other
Base (n)	1799	1146	211	108	198	136
TOTAL can shape	31 %	26 %	47 %	36 %	37 %	32 %
TOTAL inevitable	69 %	74 %	53 %	64 %	63 %	68 %
NET inevitable	39 pp	49 pp	6 pp	28 pp	26 pp	37 pp

Community

Thinking about your local community, how much are you seeing each of the following changes because of AI?

Each label stands for a full item:

Label	Item
Saving time	People are saving time on everyday tasks
Pressured to do more	People are pressured to do more, faster
Losing connections	People are losing connections to others
Real vs. fake	People are struggling to tell what's real from what's fake
Better health care	People are getting better health care

Each total combines multiple responses:

Total	Responses
TOTAL realized	"Have seen" or "Starting to see"
TOTAL not yet	"Expect to see soon" or "Don't expect to see"

Cells (weighted): totals (%) and net (percentage points).

By Sex

Item	Metric	Total	Female	Male
Base (n)		1799	915	884
Saving time	TOTAL realized	65 %	66 %	64 %
	TOTAL not yet	27 %	25 %	29 %
	NET realized	38 pp	41 pp	36 pp
Pressured to do more	TOTAL realized	53 %	55 %	51 %
	TOTAL not yet	39 %	37 %	42 %
	NET realized	14 pp	18 pp	10 pp
Losing connections	TOTAL realized	63 %	69 %	58 %
	TOTAL not yet	32 %	27 %	37 %
	NET realized	32 pp	42 pp	21 pp
Real vs. fake	TOTAL realized	92 %	94 %	89 %
	TOTAL not yet	7 %	5 %	9 %
	NET realized	85 pp	89 pp	81 pp
Better health care	TOTAL realized	17 %	14 %	20 %
	TOTAL not yet	69 %	69 %	69 %
	NET realized	−52 pp	−56 pp	−49 pp

By Party

Item	Metric	Total	Dem	Rep	Ind
Base (n)		1799	529	489	781
Saving time	TOTAL realized	65 %	63 %	76 %	60 %
	TOTAL not yet	27 %	30 %	19 %	30 %
	NET realized	38 pp	33 pp	57 pp	31 pp
Pressured to do more	TOTAL realized	53 %	55 %	49 %	54 %
	TOTAL not yet	39 %	38 %	43 %	38 %
	NET realized	14 pp	18 pp	5 pp	17 pp
Losing connections	TOTAL realized	63 %	64 %	57 %	67 %
	TOTAL not yet	32 %	32 %	39 %	27 %
	NET realized	32 pp	32 pp	19 pp	40 pp
Real vs. fake	TOTAL realized	92 %	94 %	89 %	92 %
	TOTAL not yet	7 %	5 %	10 %	6 %
	NET realized	85 pp	89 pp	79 pp	85 pp
Better health care	TOTAL realized	17 %	15 %	21 %	15 %
	TOTAL not yet	69 %	73 %	65 %	69 %
	NET realized	−52 pp	−57 pp	−43 pp	−55 pp

By Age

Item	Metric	Total	18–34	35–49	50–64	65+
Base (n)		1799	538	462	561	238
Saving time	TOTAL realized	65 %	64 %	68 %	67 %	62 %
	TOTAL not yet	27 %	29 %	25 %	25 %	29 %
	NET realized	38 pp	35 pp	44 pp	42 pp	33 pp
Pressured to do more	TOTAL realized	53 %	59 %	61 %	49 %	41 %
	TOTAL not yet	39 %	35 %	34 %	43 %	47 %
	NET realized	14 pp	25 pp	27 pp	6 pp	–7 pp
Losing connections	TOTAL realized	63 %	70 %	66 %	59 %	56 %
	TOTAL not yet	32 %	27 %	29 %	36 %	35 %
	NET realized	32 pp	43 pp	37 pp	23 pp	21 pp
Real vs. fake	TOTAL realized	92 %	92 %	92 %	91 %	91 %
	TOTAL not yet	7 %	7 %	7 %	8 %	6 %
	NET realized	85 pp	86 pp	86 pp	83 pp	85 pp
Better health care	TOTAL realized	17 %	15 %	17 %	19 %	16 %
	TOTAL not yet	69 %	73 %	70 %	67 %	66 %
	NET realized	–52 pp	–57 pp	–53 pp	–48 pp	–50 pp

By Ethnicity

Item	Metric	Total	White	Black	Asian	Mixed	Other
Base (n)		1799	1146	211	108	198	136
Saving time	TOTAL realized	65 %	65 %	68 %	74 %	63 %	60 %
	TOTAL not yet	27 %	27 %	28 %	18 %	28 %	30 %
	NET realized	38 pp	37 pp	41 pp	56 pp	36 pp	30 pp
Pressured to do more	TOTAL realized	53 %	50 %	61 %	63 %	54 %	58 %
	TOTAL not yet	39 %	41 %	32 %	35 %	41 %	37 %
	NET realized	14 pp	9 pp	30 pp	28 pp	13 pp	21 pp
Losing connections	TOTAL realized	63 %	62 %	62 %	65 %	66 %	68 %
	TOTAL not yet	32 %	32 %	33 %	33 %	29 %	29 %
	NET realized	32 pp	30 pp	28 pp	32 pp	37 pp	39 pp
Real vs. fake	TOTAL realized	92 %	92 %	85 %	97 %	94 %	90 %
	TOTAL not yet	7 %	6 %	14 %	3 %	5 %	8 %
	NET realized	85 pp	86 pp	71 pp	95 pp	88 pp	83 pp
Better health care	TOTAL realized	17 %	14 %	26 %	17 %	19 %	20 %
	TOTAL not yet	69 %	71 %	56 %	71 %	71 %	70 %
	NET realized	−52 pp	−57 pp	−30 pp	−54 pp	−52 pp	−50 pp

Families

Thinking about families in America today, how is AI affecting each of the following?

Each label stands for a full item:

Label	Item
Jobs	Job security
Future	Outlook on the future
Children	Children's well-being
Finances	Household finances

Each total combines multiple responses:

Total	Responses
TOTAL better	"Making it much better" or "Making it somewhat better"
TOTAL worse	"Making it somewhat worse" or "Making it much worse"

Cells (weighted): totals (%) and net (percentage points).

By Sex

Item	Metric	Total	Female	Male
Base (n)		1799	915	884
Jobs	TOTAL better	10 %	10 %	10 %
	TOTAL worse	86 %	86 %	85 %
	NET worse	76 pp	77 pp	75 pp
Future	TOTAL better	40 %	37 %	43 %
	TOTAL worse	55 %	59 %	52 %
	NET worse	16 pp	22 pp	9 pp
Children	TOTAL better	18 %	15 %	22 %
	TOTAL worse	69 %	73 %	64 %
	NET worse	50 pp	58 pp	43 pp
Finances	TOTAL better	34 %	31 %	37 %
	TOTAL worse	41 %	42 %	39 %
	NET worse	7 pp	11 pp	2 pp

By Party

Item	Metric	Total	Dem	Rep	Ind
Base (n)		1799	529	489	781
Jobs	TOTAL better	10 %	8 %	13 %	10 %
	TOTAL worse	86 %	89 %	82 %	86 %
	NET worse	76 pp	81 pp	68 pp	76 pp
Future	TOTAL better	40 %	37 %	54 %	33 %
	TOTAL worse	55 %	59 %	41 %	62 %
	NET worse	16 pp	23 pp	–13 pp	29 pp
Children	TOTAL better	18 %	16 %	28 %	14 %
	TOTAL worse	69 %	72 %	59 %	72 %
	NET worse	50 pp	56 pp	32 pp	58 pp
Finances	TOTAL better	34 %	29 %	46 %	30 %
	TOTAL worse	41 %	46 %	30 %	43 %
	NET worse	7 pp	18 pp	–16 pp	13 pp

By Age

Item	Metric	Total	18–34	35–49	50–64	65+
Base (n)		1799	538	462	561	238
Jobs	TOTAL better	10 %	12 %	11 %	10 %	7 %
	TOTAL worse	86 %	85 %	84 %	87 %	86 %
	NET worse	76 pp	74 pp	73 pp	77 pp	79 pp
Future	TOTAL better	40 %	30 %	39 %	44 %	50 %
	TOTAL worse	55 %	67 %	56 %	51 %	45 %
	NET worse	16 pp	38 pp	17 pp	7 pp	−4 pp
Children	TOTAL better	18 %	15 %	17 %	20 %	23 %
	TOTAL worse	69 %	75 %	71 %	65 %	61 %
	NET worse	50 pp	61 pp	54 pp	46 pp	38 pp
Finances	TOTAL better	34 %	30 %	34 %	33 %	40 %
	TOTAL worse	41 %	44 %	43 %	43 %	31 %
	NET worse	7 pp	14 pp	9 pp	10 pp	−8 pp

By Ethnicity

Item	Metric	Total	White	Black	Asian	Mixed	Other
Base (n)		1799	1146	211	108	198	136
Jobs	TOTAL better	10 %	8 %	19 %	8 %	13 %	8 %
	TOTAL worse	86 %	88 %	77 %	88 %	83 %	87 %
	NET worse	76 pp	80 pp	58 pp	80 pp	70 pp	78 pp
Future	TOTAL better	40 %	38 %	50 %	52 %	36 %	37 %
	TOTAL worse	55 %	57 %	46 %	48 %	58 %	56 %
	NET worse	16 pp	20 pp	−4 pp	−4 pp	22 pp	19 pp
Children	TOTAL better	18 %	18 %	26 %	22 %	16 %	15 %
	TOTAL worse	69 %	69 %	56 %	67 %	73 %	78 %
	NET worse	50 pp	52 pp	31 pp	45 pp	57 pp	63 pp
Finances	TOTAL better	34 %	33 %	43 %	31 %	31 %	35 %
	TOTAL worse	41 %	39 %	39 %	46 %	49 %	39 %
	NET worse	7 pp	6 pp	−3 pp	15 pp	18 pp	4 pp

Government

When it comes to each of the following issues, is the government doing too much, too little, or about the right amount in response?

Each label stands for a full item:

Label	Item
Children	AI's effects on children and young people
Environment	AI's environmental footprint, including from data centers
Workers	AI's effects on workers and jobs
Competitiveness	AI's effect on American competitiveness

Each total combines multiple responses:

Total	Responses
TOTAL too much	"Way too much" or "Somewhat too much"
TOTAL too little	"Somewhat too little" or "Way too little"

Cells (weighted): totals (%) and net (percentage points).

By Sex

Item	Metric	Total	Female	Male
Base (n)		1799	915	884
Children	TOTAL too much	16 %	18 %	15 %
	TOTAL too little	62 %	64 %	61 %
	NET too little	46 pp	46 pp	46 pp
Environment	TOTAL too much	18 %	18 %	17 %
	TOTAL too little	64 %	65 %	62 %
	NET too little	46 pp	47 pp	45 pp
Workers	TOTAL too much	17 %	19 %	16 %
	TOTAL too little	64 %	63 %	64 %
	NET too little	46 pp	44 pp	49 pp
Competitiveness	TOTAL too much	15 %	16 %	14 %
	TOTAL too little	38 %	39 %	38 %
	NET too little	23 pp	23 pp	24 pp

By Party

Item	Metric	Total	Dem	Rep	Ind
Base (n)		1799	529	489	781
Children	TOTAL too much	16 %	14 %	15 %	19 %
	TOTAL too little	62 %	71 %	53 %	62 %
	NET too little	46 pp	57 pp	38 pp	43 pp
Environment	TOTAL too much	18 %	16 %	19 %	19 %
	TOTAL too little	64 %	74 %	50 %	66 %
	NET too little	46 pp	57 pp	31 pp	48 pp
Workers	TOTAL too much	17 %	17 %	17 %	18 %
	TOTAL too little	64 %	72 %	51 %	65 %
	NET too little	46 pp	55 pp	34 pp	47 pp
Competitiveness	TOTAL too much	15 %	12 %	14 %	17 %
	TOTAL too little	38 %	44 %	32 %	38 %
	NET too little	23 pp	32 pp	18 pp	21 pp

By Age

Item	Metric	Total	18–34	35–49	50–64	65+
Base (n)		1799	538	462	561	238
Children	TOTAL too much	16 %	19 %	16 %	16 %	14 %
	TOTAL too little	62 %	65 %	62 %	59 %	62 %
	NET too little	46 pp	45 pp	46 pp	44 pp	48 pp
Environment	TOTAL too much	18 %	19 %	18 %	18 %	17 %
	TOTAL too little	64 %	68 %	62 %	62 %	64 %
	NET too little	46 pp	49 pp	44 pp	44 pp	47 pp
Workers	TOTAL too much	17 %	20 %	16 %	16 %	17 %
	TOTAL too little	64 %	64 %	66 %	64 %	60 %
	NET too little	46 pp	44 pp	50 pp	48 pp	43 pp
Competitiveness	TOTAL too much	15 %	19 %	16 %	14 %	10 %
	TOTAL too little	38 %	36 %	39 %	40 %	39 %
	NET too little	23 pp	18 pp	23 pp	26 pp	28 pp

By Ethnicity

Item	Metric	Total	White	Black	Asian	Mixed	Other
Base (n)		1799	1146	211	108	198	136
Children	TOTAL too much	16 %	14 %	25 %	17 %	15 %	23 %
	TOTAL too little	62 %	65 %	48 %	55 %	66 %	62 %
	NET too little	46 pp	51 pp	23 pp	37 pp	52 pp	39 pp
Environment	TOTAL too much	18 %	16 %	28 %	19 %	16 %	20 %
	TOTAL too little	64 %	67 %	45 %	55 %	72 %	62 %
	NET too little	46 pp	51 pp	17 pp	36 pp	56 pp	42 pp
Workers	TOTAL too much	17 %	15 %	32 %	19 %	14 %	20 %
	TOTAL too little	64 %	65 %	47 %	56 %	74 %	65 %
	NET too little	46 pp	51 pp	15 pp	38 pp	60 pp	44 pp
Competitiveness	TOTAL too much	15 %	13 %	24 %	19 %	13 %	18 %
	TOTAL too little	38 %	38 %	30 %	42 %	47 %	40 %
	NET too little	23 pp	25 pp	7 pp	23 pp	34 pp	22 pp

Futures

Thinking about the next 20 years, how likely is each of the following to happen?

Each label stands for a full item:

Label	Item
Superintelligence	AI becoming smarter than humans at most tasks
Loss-of-control	AI systems behaving in ways their developers did not intend
Breakthroughs	AI making major scientific and medical breakthroughs
WMDs	AI being used to create weapons of mass destruction

Each total combines multiple responses:

Total	Responses
TOTAL likely	"Already happening" or "Likely to happen"
TOTAL unlikely	"Unlikely to happen" or "Not at all likely to happen"

Cells (weighted): totals (%) and net (percentage points).

By Sex

Item	Metric	Total	Female	Male
Base (n)		1799	915	884
Superintelligence	TOTAL likely	73 %	72 %	73 %
	TOTAL unlikely	22 %	22 %	22 %
	NET likely	51 pp	50 pp	52 pp
Loss-of-control	TOTAL likely	80 %	81 %	79 %
	TOTAL unlikely	15 %	13 %	17 %
	NET likely	65 pp	68 pp	63 pp
Breakthroughs	TOTAL likely	76 %	73 %	79 %
	TOTAL unlikely	17 %	18 %	15 %
	NET likely	59 pp	55 pp	64 pp
WMDs	TOTAL likely	69 %	70 %	68 %
	TOTAL unlikely	18 %	15 %	21 %
	NET likely	51 pp	55 pp	47 pp

By Party

Item	Metric	Total	Dem	Rep	Ind
Base (n)		1799	529	489	781
Superintelligence	TOTAL likely	73 %	69 %	77 %	72 %
	TOTAL unlikely	22 %	25 %	19 %	21 %
	NET likely	51 pp	44 pp	58 pp	51 pp
Loss-of-control	TOTAL likely	80 %	82 %	74 %	82 %
	TOTAL unlikely	15 %	13 %	21 %	12 %
	NET likely	65 pp	69 pp	53 pp	70 pp
Breakthroughs	TOTAL likely	76 %	71 %	82 %	75 %
	TOTAL unlikely	17 %	21 %	13 %	16 %
	NET likely	59 pp	51 pp	69 pp	59 pp
WMDs	TOTAL likely	69 %	68 %	67 %	71 %
	TOTAL unlikely	18 %	17 %	22 %	17 %
	NET likely	51 pp	51 pp	45 pp	54 pp

By Age

Item	Metric	Total	18–34	35–49	50–64	65+
Base (n)		1799	538	462	561	238
Superintelligence	TOTAL likely	73 %	69 %	73 %	75 %	75 %
	TOTAL unlikely	22 %	26 %	22 %	20 %	19 %
	NET likely	51 pp	44 pp	51 pp	55 pp	56 pp
Loss-of-control	TOTAL likely	80 %	80 %	81 %	81 %	77 %
	TOTAL unlikely	15 %	15 %	15 %	14 %	14 %
	NET likely	65 pp	65 pp	66 pp	67 pp	63 pp
Breakthroughs	TOTAL likely	76 %	69 %	76 %	79 %	81 %
	TOTAL unlikely	17 %	23 %	16 %	14 %	13 %
	NET likely	59 pp	47 pp	60 pp	65 pp	69 pp
WMDs	TOTAL likely	69 %	68 %	68 %	72 %	68 %
	TOTAL unlikely	18 %	21 %	21 %	15 %	15 %
	NET likely	51 pp	47 pp	47 pp	57 pp	52 pp

By Ethnicity

Item	Metric	Total	White	Black	Asian	Mixed	Other
Base (n)		1799	1146	211	108	198	136
Superintelligence	TOTAL likely	73 %	72 %	73 %	87 %	69 %	72 %
	TOTAL unlikely	22 %	22 %	24 %	11 %	24 %	22 %
	NET likely	51 pp	50 pp	49 pp	76 pp	45 pp	50 pp
Loss-of-control	TOTAL likely	80 %	81 %	75 %	85 %	78 %	80 %
	TOTAL unlikely	15 %	13 %	22 %	10 %	15 %	17 %
	NET likely	65 pp	67 pp	52 pp	75 pp	63 pp	64 pp
Breakthroughs	TOTAL likely	76 %	76 %	77 %	85 %	72 %	75 %
	TOTAL unlikely	17 %	16 %	18 %	11 %	20 %	17 %
	NET likely	59 pp	59 pp	59 pp	74 pp	51 pp	58 pp
WMDs	TOTAL likely	69 %	69 %	71 %	61 %	74 %	69 %
	TOTAL unlikely	18 %	18 %	19 %	23 %	13 %	21 %
	NET likely	51 pp	50 pp	52 pp	38 pp	61 pp	48 pp

Appendix — Questionnaire

Reconstructed verbatim from the raw Gorilla questionnaire export: item wording, question prompts, and response options (in their presented order).

Intro, consent, and instruction screens are not captured in this export.

Priorities

> *We are faced with many problems in this country, and resources are often limited. Given these constraints, how much of a priority should the government place on each of the following?*

Items

- Improving the job situation
- Reducing inflation
- Dealing with harms from artificial intelligence (AI)
- Dealing with immigration
- Improving health care
- Reducing crime
- Dealing with climate change

Response options

1. Top priority
2. Important but lower priority
3. Not too important
4. Not a priority at all
5. Not sure

Affect

> *Thinking about AI's growing role in society, which of these options comes closest to how you feel, even if none are exactly right?*

Response options

1. Very excited
2. Somewhat excited
3. Somewhat concerned
4. Very concerned
5. None of these are close to how I feel

Agency

Again, thinking about AI, which statement comes closer to your view, even if neither is exactly right?

Response options

1. People like me can shape how much AI is part of our lives
2. AI is coming into our lives whether we want it or not

Community

Thinking about your local community, how much are you seeing each of the following changes because of AI?

Items

- People are saving time on everyday tasks
- People are pressured to do more, faster
- People are losing connections to others
- People are struggling to tell what's real from what's fake
- People are getting better health care

Response options

1. Have seen
2. Starting to see
3. Expect to see soon
4. Don't expect to see
5. Not sure

Families

Thinking about families in America today, how is AI affecting each of the following?

Items

- Job security
- Outlook on the future
- Children's well-being
- Household finances

Response options

1. Making it much better

2. Making it somewhat better
3. Making it somewhat worse
4. Making it much worse
5. Having no effect

Government

When it comes to each of the following issues, is the government doing too much, too little, or about the right amount in response?

Items

- AI's effects on children and young people
- AI's environmental footprint, including from data centers
- AI's effects on workers and jobs
- AI's effect on American competitiveness

Response options

1. Way too much
2. Somewhat too much
3. About the right amount
4. Somewhat too little
5. Way too little
6. Not sure

Futures

Thinking about the next 20 years, how likely is each of the following to happen?

Items

- AI becoming smarter than humans at most tasks
- AI systems behaving in ways their developers did not intend
- AI making major scientific and medical breakthroughs
- AI being used to create weapons of mass destruction

Response options

1. Already happening
2. Likely to happen
3. Unlikely to happen
4. Not at all likely to happen
5. Not sure

Appendix — Methodology

This is the pilot wave of the **Americans on AI** tracking survey, a project of Athena Insights.

Respondents were recruited from Prolific and completed the survey online in Gorilla between June 12 and 18, 2026. Both fieldings used the same Prolific representative sample for the United States: the *Political Affiliation & Ethnicity* sample, which is stratified on sex, age, ethnicity (simplified US Census), and political affiliation to mirror US population proportions.

Data were collected in two fieldings with recruitment targets of 1,200 and 600, combined for analysis. After keeping only complete questionnaires and dropping returned, timed-out, and consent-withdrawn submissions, 1,799 responses were retained.

Results are weighted by raking to US population targets (ACS 2024) for sex, age, and ethnicity, for a design effect of 1.10 and an effective sample size of 1,640. The achieved (unweighted) composition is disclosed in full (*Appendix — Sample composition*) per AAPOR disclosure standards.

For weighting and sample composition reporting, ethnicity is mapped to ACS race-alone (and two-or-more) categories:

- White, Black, and Asian to their race-alone groups,
- Mixed to two-or-more races, and
- Other to American Indian/Alaska Native, Native Hawaiian/Pacific Islander, and some-other-race combined.

Hispanic origin is not separable in the simplified-Census measure, so it is not a weighting target; Hispanic respondents are counted under whichever race they reported.

The questionnaire comprised 26 items in seven blocks, items randomized within blocks, with a median completion time of about 4 minutes. Participants were compensated in line with Prolific's payment guidelines.

Results are reported as response distributions, totals, and nets. Every percentage is out of all respondents, with "Not sure" and "None" answers included. Totals combine related response options, and a net is the percentage-point gap between two totals.

Appendix — Sample composition

Unweighted demographic composition of the achieved sample (n=1,799), with each weighted margin's ACS 1-year 2024 population target and the gap (sample − target, percentage points).

Party is shown for completeness but is not a weighting target (it is floated); see the methodology for the ethnicity crosswalk and the Hispanic-origin caveat. The report's figures are weighted to these targets; this table shows the achieved unweighted composition.

Dimension	Group	n	Sample %	ACS 2024 %	Gap (pp)
Sex	Female	915	51	51	−<1
	Male	884	49	49	+<1
Party	Dem	529	29	—	—
	Rep	489	27	—	—
	Ind	781	43	—	—
Age	18–34	538	30	29	+1
	35–49	462	26	25	+1
	50–64	561	31	23	+8
	65+	238	13	23	−10
Ethnicity	White	1146	64	62	+2
	Black	211	12	12	−<1
	Asian	108	6	7	−1
	Mixed	198	11	11	−<1
	Other	136	8	8	−1